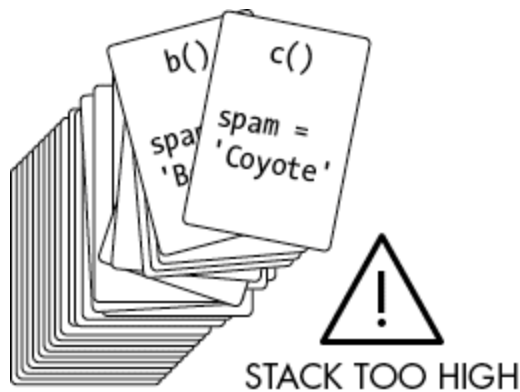


This limit is called the *maximum recursion depth* or *maximum call stack size*. For Python, this is set to 1,000 function calls. For JavaScript, the maximum call stack size depends on the browser running the code but is generally at least 10,000 or so. Think of a stack overflow as happening when the call stack gets “too high” (that is, consumes too much computer memory), as in [Figure 1-8](#).



[Figure 1-8](#): A stack overflow happens when the call stack becomes too high, with too many frame objects taking up the computer's memory.

Stack overflows don't damage the computer. The computer just detects that the limit of function calls without returns has been reached and terminates the program. At worst, you'll lose any unsaved work the program had. Stack overflows can be prevented by having something called a *base case*, which is explained next.